

**WARRANT
SPRING ANNUAL TOWN MEETING
APRIL 28, 2026**

THE COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS

Middlesex, ss

To Any Constable of the Town of Natick in said County:
Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts you are required to notify the qualified Town Meeting Members of the said Town of Natick to meet on **Tuesday, April 28, 2026, at 7:30 PM**, Kennedy Middle School, Natick, MA, then and there to act on the following Articles:

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| Article 1 | Authorize Select Board to Acquire, Obtain, Abandon or Relocate Easements |
| Article 2 | Committee Article |
| Article 3 | Omnibus Budget |
| Article 4 | Stabilization Funds and OPEB |
| Article 5 | Unpaid Bills |
| Article 6 | PEG Access and Cable Related Fund |
| Article 7 | Amend Bylaw Article 41A (Revolving Funds) |
| Article 8 | Revolving Funds |
| Article 9 | Capital Equipment and Improvement |
| Article 10 | Collective Bargaining |
| Article 11 | Personnel Board Classification and Pay Plan |
| Article 12 | An Act Authorizing the Town of Natick to Continue the Employment of Police Chief James Hicks Beyond the Age of 65 |
| Article 13 | An Act Authorizing the Town of Natick to Continue the Employment of Deputy Police Chief Brian Lauzon Beyond the Age of 65 |
| Article 14 | Amend Town Bylaw Article 50, Section 16 (Animal Control) |
| Article 15 | Community Preservation Act (CPA) Fund |
| Article 16 | Hybrid Town Meeting Committee Report, Term Extension and/or Amend Charge |
| Article 17 | Natural and Synthetic Turf Field Study Group Report |
| Article 18 | Resolution to honor the 1776 Natick Resolve for Independence and to uphold the United States Constitution in 2026 |

Article 1
Authorize Select Board to Acquire, Obtain, Abandon or Relocate Easements
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board, during Fiscal Year 2027, to acquire on behalf of the Town any and all easements for any of the following purposes: roads, sidewalks, vehicular and/or pedestrian access or passage, drainage and utilities, provided however that such authorization pertains only to easements acquired at no cost to the Town; and, further, to authorize the Select Board, subsequent to a public hearing, during Fiscal Year 2027 to abandon or relocate easements acquired for any of the foregoing purposes; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 2
Committee Article
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to hear and discuss the reports of town officers, boards, and committees; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 3
Omnibus Budget
(Town Administrator)

Town

To determine what sum of money the Town will appropriate and raise, transfer from available funds for the operation of the government of the Town of Natick, including debt and interest, during Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025, through June 30, 2026) and to provide for reserve funds for Fiscal Year 2026 and to see what budgets for Fiscal Year 2026 will be reduced to offset said additional appropriations;

To determine what sum of money the Town will appropriate and raise, or transfer from available funds for the operation of the government of the Town of Natick, including debt and interest, during Fiscal Year 2027 (July 1, 2026, through June 30, 2027) and to provide for reserve funds for Fiscal Year 2027;

Libraries

To determine what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, or otherwise provide, for the maintenance and operation of the Morse Institute Library and the Bacon Free Library, for Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025, through June 30, 2026);

To determine what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, or otherwise provide, for the maintenance and operation of the Morse Institute Library and the Bacon Free Library, for Fiscal Year 2027 (July 1, 2026, through June 30, 2027); or otherwise act thereon.

Article 4
Stabilization Funds and OPEB
(Town Administrator)

General Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Stabilization Fund established under Article 22 of the warrant for Annual Town Meeting of 1961, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

Operational Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Operational Stabilization Fund established by vote of the 2011 Spring Annual Town Meeting under Article 4, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

Capital Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Capital Stabilization Fund established by vote of the 2010 Fall Annual Town Meeting under Article 2, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

OPEB

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for, the Other Post-Employment Benefits Liability Trust Fund established by vote of the 2017 Spring Annual Town Meeting under Article 15, pursuant to the provisions of Chapter 32B, Section 20 of the General Laws as amended by section 15 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 5
Unpaid Bills
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide for the payment of unpaid bills of previous years, incurred by the departments, boards and officers of the Town of Natick; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 6
PEG Access and Cable Related Fund
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from the PEG Access and Cable Related Fund, established by vote of 2019 Special Town Meeting #1 under Article 1, as authorized by Chapter 44, Section 53F 3/4 of the General Laws, as amended, to fund PEG access programming, as well as certain other municipal cable related expenses; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 7
Amend Bylaw Article 41A (Revolving Funds)
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to amend Article 41A (Revolving Funds) of the Natick Town Bylaws as provided for under Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, section 53E 1/2; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 8
Revolving Funds
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote on the limit of the total amount that may be expended from each revolving fund established pursuant to Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 44, section 53E 1/2 and Article 41A (Revolving Funds) of the Natick Town Bylaws; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 9
Capital Equipment and Improvement
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, borrow, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide to implement a Capital Improvement Program as may be required for capital equipment for the various departments of the Town of Natick; to protect the physical infrastructure of the Town of Natick, to add new physical infrastructure, or to improve community assets; and further to determine whether this appropriation shall be raised by borrowing or otherwise; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 10
Collective Bargaining
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide, to implement any Collective Bargaining Agreements between the Town of Natick and any recognized bargaining units of the Town; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 11
Personnel Board Classification and Pay Plan
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town, pursuant to the authority contained in Section 108A of Chapter 41 of the General Laws, will vote to amend Article 24 of the Natick Town Bylaws, specifically the Classification and Pay Plan referenced in Section 3, paragraph 3.10 therein, by adding, deleting or amending position titles; re-classifying positions to a different Grade; and/or effecting changes in the salary ranges as presently established; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 12
An Act Authorizing the Town of Natick to Continue the Employment of Police Chief James Hicks Beyond the Age Of 65
(Select Board)

To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to file Special Legislation with the General Court under the Home Rule Amendment to the Massachusetts Constitution or take any other action thereon, said Special Legislation to read as follows; provided, however, that the General Court may make clerical or editorial changes of form only to the bill, unless the Select Board approves amendments thereto before enactment by the General Court, which amendments shall be within the public purposes of said petition; or otherwise act thereon.

AN ACT AUTHORIZING THE TOWN OF NATICK TO CONTINUE THE
EMPLOYMENT OF POLICE CHIEF JAMES HICKS BEYOND THE AGE OF 65.

SECTION I. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, James Hicks, Police Chief of the Town of Natick, may continue to serve in that position until reaching age 67, the date of his retirement, or the date he is relieved of his duties by the Select Board at their discretion, whichever occurs first; provided, however, that he is mentally and physically capable of performing the duties of Police Chief. The Select Board may, at the Town's own expense, require that James Hicks be examined annually by a physician designated by the Select Board, to determine such physical and mental capability to perform the duties of his office.

No further deductions shall be made from the regular compensation of James Hicks, pursuant to chapter 32 of the General Laws for service subsequent to his reaching age 65; and upon retirement for superannuation, he shall receive a superannuation retirement allowance equal to the allowance that he would have been entitled had he retired upon reaching age 65

Article 13
An Act Authorizing the Town of Natick to Continue the Employment of Deputy Police Chief Brian Lauzon Beyond the Age of 65
(Select Board)

To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to file Special Legislation with the General Court under the Home Rule Amendment to the Massachusetts Constitution or take any other action thereon, said Special Legislation to read as follows; provided, however, that the General Court may make clerical or editorial changes of form only to the bill, unless the Select Board approves amendments thereto before enactment by the General Court, which amendments shall be within the public purposes of said petition; or otherwise act thereon.

AN ACT AUTHORIZING THE TOWN OF NATICK TO CONTINUE THE
EMPLOYMENT OF DEPUTY POLICE CHIEF BRIAN LAUZON BEYOND THE AGE OF 65

SECTION I. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, Brian Lauzon, Deputy Police Chief of the Town of Natick, may continue to serve in that position until reaching age 67, the date of his retirement, or the date he is relieved of his duties by the Select Board at their discretion, whichever occurs first; provided, however, that he is mentally and physically capable of performing the duties of Deputy Police Chief. The Select Board may, at the Town's own expense, require that Brian Lauzon be examined annually by a physician designated by the Select Board, to determine such physical and mental capability to perform the duties of his office.

No further deductions shall be made from the regular compensation of Brian Lauzon, pursuant to chapter 32 of the General Laws for service subsequent to his reaching age 65; and upon retirement for superannuation, he shall receive a superannuation retirement allowance equal to the allowance that he would have been entitled had he retired upon reaching age 65

Article 14
Amend Bylaw Article 50, Section 16 (Animal Control)
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will amend Natick Town Bylaws Article 50, Section 16 (Animal Control); or otherwise act thereon.

Article 15
Community Preservation Fund: Appropriation of Community Preservation Funds
(Community Preservation Committee)

To see if the Town will vote to appropriate the Community Preservation Fund annual revenues into each of the Community Preservation Act (CPA) accounts, which include Community (Affordable) Housing, Open Space and Recreation, and Historic Resources; and further appropriate annual revenues for administration and operation for use by the Community Preservation Committee (CPC) in Fiscal Year 2027, in accordance with General Laws Chapter 44B, or otherwise act thereon.

ARTICLE 16
Hybrid Town Meeting Committee Report, Term Extension and/or Amend Charge
(Hybrid Town Meeting Committee)

To see what action the Town will take to hear and/or discuss a report of the Hybrid Town Meeting Committee; and to see what action Town Meeting will take to: 1) extend the term of the Hybrid Town Meeting Committee and/or 2) amend the charge of the committee. Or otherwise act thereon.

Article 17
Natural and Synthetic Turf Field Study Group Report
(Select Board)

To see if the Town will vote to hear and/or discuss the report of the Natural and Synthetic Turf Field Study Group, or otherwise act thereon.

Article 18
Resolution to honor the 1776 Natick Resolve for Independence and to uphold the United
States Constitution in 2026
(Joshua Ostroff et al)

To see if the Town will vote to approve a resolution commemorating the 250th anniversary of the Natick Town Meeting Resolve for Independence, and affirming Natick support of the Constitution of the United States, or otherwise act thereon.

You are directed to serve this Warrant by causing an attested copy of said Warrant to be posted in the Post Office in said Natick, and at the following public places in said Natick, to wit: Precinct 1: Reliable Cleaners, 214 West Central Street; Precinct 2: Cole Recreation Center, 179 Boden Lane; Precinct 3: Kennedy Middle School, Mill Street; Precinct 4: 2 Summer St.; Precinct 5: Wilson Middle School, Rutledge Road; Precinct 6: East Natick Fire Station, Rhode Island Avenue; Precinct 7: Lilja Elementary School, Bacon Street; Precinct 8: Natick High School, 15 West Street; Precinct 9: Community Senior Center, 117 East Central Street; and Precinct 10: Memorial Elementary School, 107 Eliot Street.

Above locations being at least one public place in each Precinct, in the Town of Natick, and also posted in the Natick U.S. Post Office, Town Hall, Bacon Free Library and Morse Institute Library seven days at least before April 28, 2026; also by causing the titles of the articles on the Warrant for the 2026 Spring Annual Town Meeting to be published once in "*The Metrowest Daily News*" with notice of availability of an attested copy of said Warrant, said Newspaper published in the Town of Natick and said publication to be March 6, 2026.

Hereof fail not and make due return of this Warrant with your doings thereon to the Town Clerk at or before the time appointed for holding said meeting.

Given under our hands this 2nd day of March, 2026.

Select Board for the Town of Natick



Bruce T. Evans, Chair



Linda Wollschlager, Vice-Chair



Kristen L. Pope, Clerk



Kathryn M. Coughlin



Richard Sidney

Certified copies of the Warrant are available at the Office of the Town Clerk, Natick Town Hall, 13 East Central St., Natick, MA between the hours of 8:00 a.m. – 4:30 p.m., Monday through Wednesday; 8:00 a.m.- 6:00 p.m. on Thursday; and 8:00 a.m.-12:30 p.m. on Friday. The Warrant may also be accessed from the Town website www.natickma.gov